

MARKETING SWEET · ROLEPLAY 04

The 6+12 Contract Structure

Session tie-in: Session 04 — Rock Solid is the Energy, Say It Then Deliver It

Difficulty: Intermediate · **Run time:** ~15 min · **Reps required:** 2

The setup

You're on a video call with **Dave Cooper**, owner of *Cooper Plumbing & Gas* — 14 staff, mostly residential, decent foothold in commercial maintenance. Dave's been in business 22 years, knows his numbers, doesn't suffer fools. ~\$2.5M turnover.

Two years ago, Dave signed a 12-month contract with another marketing agency. They took \$24k, delivered very little, and ghosted him. He's still angry. You only know this because he mentioned it in passing during the discovery call.

You've just pitched him an SEO + content package — \$1,200/month, 12-month minimum term. The pitch landed. Affordability — checked. Intent — confirmed. He likes you. But the moment you said "12 months" his jaw set.

You are the rep. Dave just said:

DAVE: Mate, I'll do this with you, but I'm not signing a 12-month contract. Six months max. I got burned by [other agency] before — twelve months, twenty-four grand, fuck all to show for it. Not doing it again.

Coaching note — before you start: The wrong move here is the easy one — ferry the message back to the office, ask for "permission" to do six months. That breaks your rock-solid energy and trains Dave that any decision he names becomes the new floor. The right move is to solve his problem on the call, on your authority, with a structure he can't say no to.

THE SCRIPT

REP: Dave — heard you. Two things first. One: completely fair. After what happened with [other agency], I wouldn't sign a 12-month with anyone either. Anyone telling you otherwise hasn't been burned. Two: SEO compounds. Six months gets us through the slow part — building the foundation. The compound results land between months 6 and 18. So I want to give you the structure that protects you AND lets the work actually deliver.

DAVE: *[Skeptical]* Go on.

REP: Here's what I'm going to propose. You sign a 6-month initial agreement with us today. *Just* six months. At the end of month six — we sit down again. If we've delivered, results are

showing, you're happy with the team — we sign a fresh 12-month contract for the next phase. If we haven't delivered, you walk. No penalty, no extension, no hard feelings.

Coaching note: That's the 6+12 structure verbatim. Notice the framing — you're not asking him to commit to 12 months. You're asking him to commit to *six*. The 12 comes later, AFTER you've earned it. This is the Session 04 rock-solid move: structure the deal around the prospect's real concern, then deliver against it.

DAVE: *[Pauses]* So six months upfront, then we re-up — what's the total commitment if we go the distance?

REP: 6 + 12 = 18 months. Total \$21,600 over the 18 months. Same monthly rate, no jump.

DAVE: And if I walk at month six?

REP: \$7,200 total — what you've paid for those six months. No exit fee. No “but you owe us another six.” We just shake hands and you've got a stronger SEO position than when you started.

DAVE: Why am I more likely to re-up at month six than I would be on the day I sign a 12-month today?

Coaching note: Great question from Dave. He's testing whether you've thought this through. Don't get defensive — give him the honest answer.

REP: Because at month six you've seen the results. The risk you're trying to avoid right now is *committing to twelve months of work you can't predict the quality of*. The 6+12 removes that — you only commit to the second phase if you've already lived the first. The decision becomes easier, not harder. That's why I'd rather give you an off-ramp at month six than fight you for a 12-month signature today.

DAVE: *[Nods slowly]* Alright. What about a month-four review?

Coaching note: This is the prospect renegotiating the deadline. Don't let him. Month four is too early for SEO results to land. If you let him set the review at month four, you've built a deal that's likely to fail at the review point, lose the renewal, and erode your rock-solid energy. Hold the six.

REP: I'd love to give you month four, mate, but it'd be dishonest. SEO doesn't show its real momentum until month four-five at the earliest. If we review at month four you'll see early signals — keyword movement, traffic up, but probably not the leads we both want yet. Month six gives us a real conversation. I'd rather you walk at month six with real data than walk at month four because the picture wasn't fair yet. Six months is the right call.

DAVE: *[Pauses again. Then:]* Yeah. Okay. Six months.

REP: Mate, I'll send you the link. All I need is a deposit and we can lock in the kick-off call. What day next week works for the kick-off — Tuesday or Wednesday?

Coaching note: Straight into the assumption close (Session 04 + Session 05). You didn't say “are you happy to proceed?” You didn't say “great, when you're ready,

let me know.” You went to logistics. Default state of the conversation is yes. Help him get there.

THE FORK — Dave goes harder on price:

DAVE: Mate, the structure’s good, but can you do \$1,000 a month instead of \$1,200? That’s the only way I can stomach committing to six months upfront.

Coaching note: Don’t panic-drop. Don’t go back to the office. Hold the line and either trade something for something, or hold the price.

REP: Dave — I can’t take it to a grand. That’d undercut what we deliver at this tier and I’d rather not start the work if I can’t deliver it right. What I can do — if you sign in the next 48 hours — is comp the first month’s content production, which is normally \$400. That’s effectively the saving you’d be looking for, just structured differently. Yes or no?

Coaching note: Notice — same final outcome (he pays ~\$200 less per month equivalent in month one), but you held the rate. Holding the rate matters because if you drop the rate, every month for the next 6 (or 18) months he’s being reminded that you fold under pressure. Holding the rate, but giving him a one-time concession — preserves the rock-solid energy.

STRETCH VARIATIONS

- **Dave wants a 3-month trial.** Don’t do it. SEO doesn’t show results in 3 months. Hold the line at six. If he insists, walk. A bad 3-month deal is worse than no deal.
 - **Dave tries to negotiate down at month 6.** Trickier — go back to the original Session 04 framing: results, not effort. If results are there, the rate stays. If they’re not, fair enough to walk.
 - **Dave accepts six months but wants to defer the start to next quarter.** Probe gently — is this a real timing reason or a soft no? Use the isolation question: “All things aside, if we could start October 1, would you sign today?”
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WHAT TO LOOK FOR WHEN YOU’RE PRACTISING THIS

- Did the rep validate Dave’s concern *before* proposing the structure?
- Did they ferry the decision back to “let me check with my office” at any point?
- Did they fold on month-six → month-four under pressure?
- Did they go straight to the assumption close, or did they pause and ask “would you like to proceed?”
- When Dave pushed for a \$1,000 rate, did the rep panic-drop or hold?

This roleplay is the litmus test for whether a rep can deliver rock-solid energy when the prospect has real reason to be skeptical. Run it three times and rotate. Note when the rep flinches — that's the part to drill next.